

Industry Leaders' Views



"This Budget, unlike any other, has not treated technology in isolation but integrated the effective use of technology across all the strategic imperatives in keeping with the intent of a digital India. It has laid emphasis on governance reforms and ease of doing business, while highlighting the need for enhancing educational skills.

"However, we are disappointed with the announcement of R&D incentives being reduced, because this move could be detrimental in building India as an innovation hub. I strongly urge the government to reconsider this move, as any restrictions on the R&D ecosystem are likely to decelerate innovation and restrain the ambitious Make in India and Digital India vision." —**Debjani Ghosh, president, MAIT**



"The government impetus being given to Make in India initiative by providing tax and duty benefits will boost the manufacturing sector for a long period of time and strengthen the manufacturing capabilities of Indian companies. The industry today is well equipped to address environmental concerns; however,

the government should consider formulating a coherent policy, wherein development and environment conservation go hand-in-hand. The government should also place emphasis on incentivising the manufacture of energy-efficient and eco-friendly products." —**Manish Sharma, president, CEAMA and MD, Panasonic India and South Asia**



"The effort to incentivise the Make in India programme by way of domestic value addition in the EMS segment is a step in the right direction as is the removal of customs duties. This augurs well for us, as majority of spending in our industry is on imported ESDM items." —**Sunil Khanna, president and MD,**

Emerson Network Power India



"Given the challenges the finance minister has to contend with to meet the high expectations of various sectors of the industry, SMEs, big corporate houses, the middle class and social sectors, the Budget has come up to our expectations. He has drawn a roadmap for relief to all sectors; as GDP growth gets accelerated, it

will lead to higher revenues available with the government." —**Vikram Desai, president, ELCINA and MD, Desai Electronics Pvt Ltd**



"Imports of assembled sub-systems like chargers/adaptors, batteries and wired headsets/speakers for the manufacture of mobile phones will cost 16.5 per cent more due to withdrawal of BCD and SAD.

"On the other hand, inputs, parts, components and the sub-parts for manufacturing these and other electronics sub-systems have been reduced to zero per cent. Further, imports of populated PCBs will cost two per cent to four per cent more. Both reflect a strong commitment to promoting local value addition in electronics." —**Vinay Shenoy, chairman, IESA and MD, Infineon Technologies**



"The IGCD procedure has been simplified, allowing duty exemptions to importers/manufacturers based on self-declaration, obviating the need for permissions from the central excise authorities. Various provisions for the sector announced in the Budget would, in the long term, encourage domestic value-added manufactur-

ing of electronics hardware and make it as competitive as imports. The announcements are in line with Make in India initiative and towards reducing transaction costs. However, a lot more needs to be done to develop India as an electronics manufacturing hub." —**Vinod Sharma, chairman, CII National Committee on ICTE Manufacturing and MD, Deki Electronics Ltd**

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